

Boom!

Sit on the floor on either side of an empty plastic bowl and take turns dropping an easy-to-grip bean bag or ball into the bowl. Say “Boom!” as the bean bag hits the base of the bowl to make your baby giggle. Sprinkle some flour into the bowl if you want flour dust to fly up as the bean bag hits the base to give him a greater sense of cause and effect.

shoot and splash

Your baby is grasping concepts such as “in” and “out” now. Develop his understanding of this by resting a long tube, large enough to hold a bouncy ball, over the edge of a saucepan or bowl filled with water. Show your baby how to put the ball into one end of the tube so it rolls out at the other end into the water. Describe how quickly or slowly the ball moves through the tube and reappears as you tip the tube up and down—he’ll be intrigued by what is happening.